

2c. Content of Developments in Islamic thought (H573/04)

In this component, learners have the opportunity to undertake a systematic study of key concepts within the development of Islamic thought. Learners will explore religious beliefs, values and teachings, their interconnections, how they have developed historically and how they are presently discussed.

By studying the role of prophecy, revelation and tradition learners will develop an understanding of Islamic sources of wisdom and authority, including scripture and key religious figures, and how these influence the beliefs and practices that shape and express Islamic religious identity.

In exploring Islamic ideas about the nature and existence of God, learners will be introduced to different theological and philosophical views, enabling them to consider the diversity within the Islamic tradition.

The topic *Human Destiny* explores Islamic ideas regarding the self and the meaning and purpose of life, as well as the afterlife. This study will give learners an insight into the motivations and spiritual goals of Muslims.

The Shari'a is an important area of study which will deepen learners' understanding of the Islamic community; their religious leaders and the interpretation and application of scripture and tradition in everyday life.

In studying Sufism, learners will explore a mystical dimension of Islam and the way in which this is practised. This topic enables discussion of a distinct and interesting approach to Islam, highlighting its diversity.

By looking at the transmission of scientific and philosophical knowledge, learners will be able to reflect upon the cultural interaction between Islam and the West over the course of history. *Science and Philosophy* enables discussion of Muslim contributions to areas of scientific learning and also a comparison of the ideas from two key scholars: Abu Hamid al-Ghazali and Ibn Rushd (Averroes).

The next topic focuses on the changing cultural norms in relation to gender. An area of debate which will be familiar to learners, this topic enables the study of Islam to be made especially relevant to issues central to modern society, as well as the lives of Muslim men and women around the world.

In *Tolerance*, learners will be able to explore how Muslims relate to members of other faiths and belief systems. This topic will also look at important issues and challenges related to religious freedom in Muslim society.

In the topic *Justice and Liberation*, learners will explore issues related to social liberation and protection of rights, including the study of two key scholars; Ali Shari'ati and Abdal Hakim Murad.

In *Islam and the State*, learners will undertake the important exploration of changing ideas about the relationship between Islam and political systems, in particular the challenge of secularisation and modernity.

Finally in *Islam in Europe*, learners will discuss the issues and challenges raised by migration and multiculturalism, related to Muslims living as minorities in modern, Western, secular societies.

Technical Terms

While the majority of non-English terms (which are not names of texts, philosophical schools, or particular religious approaches) given within the specification and assessment materials will be accompanied by a translation, there are some that are considered to be key technical terms that learners are expected to recognise and understand without a provided translation.

For this component, the following are considered technical terms and will not necessarily be accompanied by a translation:

- *Barzakh*
- *Hadith*
- *Hijab*
- *Ijtihad*
- *Sira*.

The spelling of words which have been transliterated from non-Roman alphabets will be used consistently through the assessment materials. Learners will not be penalised for the use of other common spellings.

1. Foundations

The origins and development of Islam, including the sources of wisdom on which it is based

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Prophecy and Revelation*	- The Muslim view of prophecy (<i>nubuwwa</i>) and revelation (<i>wahy</i>) - Key prophets of the Abrahamic tradition: - Ibrahim (Abraham) - Musa (Moses) - Isa (Jesus) - The Prophet Muhammad (pbuh)	- the angel Jibril (Gabriel) as the medium of revelation - the difference between a prophet (<i>nabi</i>) and a messenger (<i>rasul</i>) - the study of these three prophets to include their significance in Muslim belief and practice as: - carriers of revelation - founding figures of Abrahamic religious traditions - sources of moral example and inspiration for Muslims - the significance of the Qur'an as the final revelation to humanity - the status of the prophet Muhammad as 'the seal of the prophets' (<i>khatam al-nabiyyin</i>) in Qur'an 33:40 - the commemoration of the revelation of the Qur'an and the prophet Muhammad in everyday ritual and religious festivals
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to prophecy and revelation, including: - the centrality and importance of belief in revelation and prophecy for Islam - the relationship between the Islamic religious tradition and earlier Abrahamic faiths - the roles of Muhammad as the final messenger to humanity, and the Qur'an as the foundational scripture of the Muslim community		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Lings, M. (1988) <i>Muhammad: His life based on the earliest sources</i>, Unwin, Chapters 6 and 15 - Wheeler, B. (2002) <i>Prophets in the Quran: An Introduction to the Quran and Muslim Exegesis</i>, Continuum, pages 83–109, 173–198, 297–319, 321–335 - Al-Azami, M. M. 'The Islamic view of the Quran' in Nasr, S.H. (ed) (2015) <i>The Study Quran: A New Translation and Commentary</i>, HarperCollins		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Tradition*	- Hadith and Sira as sources for the life of the Prophet Muhammad - The formation of the Sunni and Shi'a traditions, and their differing views on leadership and religious authority following the death of the prophet Muhammad	- differences between Hadith and Sira in terms of composition and their approach to the transmission of prophetic reports - the role of Hadith and Sira as sources of historical knowledge and religious wisdom <i>Sahih al-Bukhari</i> (Chapter 1) and <i>Sira Ibn Hisham</i> on the event of the first revelation to the Prophet Muhammad - Shi'a tradition - Shi'a accounts of the prophet's designation of Ali as leader - the infallible Imams as sources of wisdom and divine guidance - the significance of revering the prophet's family (<i>ahl al-bayt</i>) - Sunni tradition - Sunni accounts of Abu Bakr's appointment through community consensus - the early Muslim community (<i>salaf</i>) as sources of wisdom and transmission of prophetic guidance - the significance of community consensus
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to community and tradition, including: - the significance of the prophet Muhammad's life and death in the formation of the early Muslim community and different traditions within Islam - how the different narratives of succession relate to and explain the the major differences between Sunnism and Shi'ism		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful - Brown, J.A.C. (2009) <i>Hadith: Muhammad's Legacy in the Medieval and Modern World</i>, Oneworld, Chapters 2, 3 and 9 - Selections from Asad, M. (1935 plus several later reprints) <i>Sahih al-Bukhari: Being the true account of the sayings and doings of the Prophet Muhammad</i>, Arafat Publications - Selections from Tabataba'i, S.M.H. al-Tabataba'i & Chittick, W. (trans), (1981) <i>A Shi'ite Anthology</i>, State University of New York Press - Madelung, W. (1997) <i>The Succession to Muhammad: A Study of the Early Caliphate</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapter 1		

2. Insight

Beliefs, teachings and ideas about human life, the world and ultimate reality

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
God is One*	- The existence and oneness of God, including: - theological arguments in the Qur'an - interpretation of the anthropomorphic descriptions of God as in the Qur'an	- study to include: - Qur'an 42:11 and 112:1–4 on divine transcendence - the Kalam cosmological argument (3:190) and teleological argument (23:12–13) - the argument that there cannot be two equally omnipotent powers (21:22) - the approaches of: - Mu'tazilism - Ash'arism - Hanbalism
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the existence and nature of God, including: - the significance of the belief in one God for Islam - evaluation of the arguments for the existence and oneness of God and the interpretations of descriptions of God in the Qur'an - a comparison and evaluation of the different interpretations of the anthropomorphic descriptions of God in the Qur'an	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Shihadeh, A. 'The existence of God' in Winter, T.J. (2008) <i>Cambridge Companion to Classical Islamic Theology</i>, Cambridge University Press - Al-Ghazali, A.H.M. & Yaqub A.M. (2013) <i>al-Ghazali's "Moderation in Belief"</i>, University of Chicago Press, selections from first and second treatise - Chowdury, S.Z. (2009) <i>Early Kalam Controversies</i>, Ad-Duha, Part 3	

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Human Destiny*	- Qur'anic teachings on the meaning of human existence - The afterlife - Divine will and human action	- the three main reasons for human existence given by the Qur'an: - Adam's creation and the knowledge of God - worship of God - moral tribulation - the reflection of divine justice and mercy in different phases of the afterlife: - the Barzakh as the intermediary phase between death and resurrection - the Day of Resurrection (<i>yawm al-qiyama</i>) - heaven and hell as final destinations - two major theological approaches to the question of divine will and human action: - Mu'tazilism - Ash'arism - Ghazali, discussion of divine will and human action in <i>The Jerusalem Epistle</i>, III (The Third Pillar of Faith) on human free will, divine justice and divine omnipotence
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the nature of human existence, including: - the significance of the belief in the afterlife in the Islamic tradition - the role of divine justice and mercy in Islamic eschatological teachings - the strengths and weaknesses of different theological approaches to the idea of human free will and divine omnipotence in Islam		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful - Winter, T.J. (1989) <i>The Remembrance of Death and the Afterlife: Book XL of the Revival of the Religious Sciences</i>, Islamic Texts Society - Tibawi, A.L. (1965) "Al-Ghazali's Tract on Dogmatic Theology", <i>Islamic Quarterly</i>, Vol.9, pp.65–122. - Smith, J.I & Haddad, Y. (1981) <i>The Islamic Understanding of Death and Resurrection</i>, State University of New York Press, Chapters 2 and 4		

3. Living

The diversity of ethics and practice, including those that shape and express religious identity, the role of the community of believers and key moral principles

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
The Shari'a*	- The Shari'a as an ideal - The Shari'a in practice, including: - Islamic law (<i>fiqh</i>) as an interpretive effort (<i>ijtihad</i>) <i>Ijtihad</i> in practice	- the meaning of 'Shari'a' - sources of Islamic law, including: - scriptural (Qur'an, Sunna) - non-scriptural (consensus of the community, analogical reasoning, custom) - the concept of <i>ijtihad</i> (human interpretative effort) - the concepts of <i>taqlid</i> (following past scholarly authority) and <i>ijtihad</i> within the framework of the school of law (<i>madhhab</i>) - the extension of the Qur'anic prohibition on alcohol to other drugs by means of analogical reasoning (<i>qiyas</i>) - the Qur'anic prohibition on usury and banking institutions - the role of scientific findings in the growing consensus on the prohibition on tobacco
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the Shari'a, including: - the centrality of the Shari'a and Islamic law in the daily practice of Muslims - the difference between the Shari'a as an ideal and Islamic law in practice - how the limits of human interpretation of the Shari'a may lead to tolerance of diversity within Muslim practice - Islamic law as an ongoing interpretive effort and its application to new problems in Muslim living	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Hallaq, W. (2009) <i>An Introduction to Islamic Law</i>, Cambridge University Press, Part 1 - Selections from Kamali, M.H. (2005) <i>Principles of Islamic Jurisprudence</i>, Islamic Texts Society - Batran, A. (2003) <i>Tobacco Smoking under Islamic Law: Controversy over its introduction</i>, Amana, Chapters 2,3 and 4	

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Sufism*	- Islamic spirituality - Sufism - theory - practice	- the concept of <i>ihsan</i> (spiritual perfection) in the Gabriel hadith - remembrance of God (<i>dhikr</i>) - self-purification (<i>tazkiyat al-nafs</i>) - drunken Sufism: the concept of annihilation of the self (<i>fana'</i>) ecstatic utterances (<i>shatahat</i>) - sober Sufism: the concept of persistence of self (<i>baqa'</i>) the description of spiritual states and stations - the concept of 'friendship of God' (<i>wilaya</i>) - the Sufi master-disciple relationship - the Sufi path (<i>tariqa</i>) - the spiritual journey according to Jalal al-Din al-Rumi's <i>Mathnavi/Masnavi</i>, 'Song of the Reed'
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Sufism, including: - the significance of spiritual perfection in the Islamic tradition - the relationship between Sufism and the wider Islamic tradition - the centrality of the idea of spiritual training in the Sufi tradition and the importance of the Sufi master	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Ernst, C. (1997) <i>The Shambala Guide to Sufism</i>, Shambala, Chapters 1, 4 and 5 - Sells, M. (1997) <i>Early Islamic Mysticism: Sufi, Qur'an, Mi'raj, Poetic and Theological Writings</i>, Paulist Press, Introduction and Chapter 1 - Chittick, W. (1984) <i>The Sufi Path of Love: The Spiritual Teachings of Rumi</i>, State University of New York Press, Part III, C and E	

4. Development

Significant social and historical developments in Islamic thought, such as those influenced by ethics, philosophy or studies of religion

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Science and Philosophy	- the Islamic contribution to science - a comparison of the views of al-Ghazali and Ibn Rushd (Averroes) on the adoption of science and philosophy	- the Qur'an's encouragement of scientific enquiry - instances of contribution to science in the medieval period, for example in the areas of medicine, mathematics and astronomy - study of Ghazali to include: - Ghazali's two crises and salvation through Sufism and religious experience - assessment of the philosophers in <i>al-Munqidh min al-Dalal</i> (Deliverance from Error), III.2 - study of Ibn Rushd's defence of Philosophy: - argument for the necessity of philosophy according to the Shari'a - refutation of Ghazali's attack on philosophers three levels of religious knowledge (rhetorical, dialectical, demonstrative)
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the Islamic contribution to science and philosophy, including: - the role of scientific learning in the medieval period and its contributions to modern science - religious arguments encouraging the study of science and philosophy - the impact of science and philosophy on religious thought in Islam		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Ghazali, A.H.M. & Watt. M. (1995) <i>The Faith and Practice of al-Ghazali: al-Munqidh min al-Dalal</i>, Oneworld, Book 1 - Selections from Hourani, G. (1961) <i>Averroes on the Harmony of Religion and Philosophy</i>, Gidd Memorial Trust, - Dallal, A. (2012) <i>Islam, Science and the Challenge of History</i>, Yale University Press, Chapters 2 and 3		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Gender Equality	- spiritual equality of the genders according to the Shari'a and early Muslim tradition - Islamic law and cultural norms in relation to gender, including: - traditional views - modern feminism	- the Qur'anic view that men and women are spiritually equal - the importance of women in early Islam - the impact of different traditional cultural norms on religious practice, with respect to: - family law - the laws of modesty (<i>awra</i>) - study to include the impact of feminism on: - new feminist readings of the Qur'an - different attitudes towards the <i>hijab</i>
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related Islam and gender, including: - whether or not there is gender equality in the Islamic tradition - the degree to which Islamic practice is influenced by local cultural norms - evaluation of the new feminist interpretations of the Qur'an - whether the Muslim veil is a symbol of oppression or resistance	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Tucker, J.E. (2008) <i>Women, Family and Gender in Islamic Law</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapters 2 and 3 - Barlas, A. (2003) <i>Believing Women in Islam: Unreading Patriarchal Interpretations of the Qur'an</i>, University of Texas Press, Part II - Roded, R.(ed) (2008) <i>Women in Islam and the Middle East</i>, London: I.B. Tauris, Chapters 1–3	

5. Society

The relationship between religion and society, including issues such as how religions adapt when encountering different cultures; religious tolerance, respect and recognition and views of other religions and non-religious worldviews; religion, equality and discrimination; the political and social influence of religious institutions

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Tolerance	- tolerance of non-Muslims according to the Qur'an - religious freedom in Muslim society: - non-Muslim minorities - apostasy	- the idea of Islam as the final religion in Qur'an 3:19 - Qur'an 2:256 on religious freedom - the concept of 'people of the Book' (<i>ahl al-kitab</i>) - the contract of <i>dhimma</i> in classical Islamic law - the treatment of religious minorities in medieval Muslim society - non-Muslim minorities and the concept of citizenship in modern Muslim states - Ghazali's <i>Faysal al-tafriqa</i> on the definition of apostasy according to Islamic law - anti-apostasy laws in Islam and their contemporary interpretation
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Islam and tolerance, including: - the Islamic view of other religious traditions - Muslim tolerance towards non-Muslims in theory and in practice - the impact of modernisation on traditional Muslim approaches to interreligious tolerance - comparison of traditional and contemporary Muslim views on apostasy		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Selections from Jackson, S. (2002) <i>On the Boundaries of Theological Tolerance in Islam: Abu Hamid al-Ghazali's Faysal al-Tafriqa</i>, Oxford University Press - Friedmann, Y. (2010) <i>Tolerance and Coercion in Islam: Interfaith relations in the Muslim tradition</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapters 1 and 4 - Abou El Fadl, K. (ed) (2002) <i>The Place of Tolerance in Islam</i>, Beacon Press, pages 3–26		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Justice and Liberation	- justice and liberation in the Qur'an and Sunna: - justice in Islamic law and ethics: - contemporary approaches to social liberation in Islam: - Ali Shari'ati - Abdal Hakim Murad	- the commandment to uphold justice and perform <i>al-amr bil-ma'ruf wal-nahy 'an al-munkar</i> (enjoining good and forbidding wrong) - the commandment to perform lesser and greater Jihad - the importance of mercy in the conduct of the Prophet Muhammad and early Muslims <i>qisas</i> (retribution) and <i>diya</i> (restitution) in Islamic criminal law - the concept of public interest (<i>maslaha</i>) in Islamic legal theory 'enjoining good and forbidding wrong' as a communal responsibility (<i>fard kifaya</i>); the protection of individual rights in its enforcement - influence of Marxist ideas; criticism of Sunnism and apolitical Shi'ism; involvement in the Iranian Revolution - traditionalist Sufi approach; criticism of Islamist revivalism; call for return to 'activism within'
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Islam, justice and liberation, including: - the role of justice, liberation and mercy in foundational Islamic teachings - the ways in which individual rights and public interest are balanced in Islamic law and ethics - different contemporary Muslim views on the struggle for justice and liberation		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful - Cook, M. (2203) <i>Forbidding Wrong in Islam: an introduction</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapters 2, 3 and 8 - Selections from Rahnema, A. (1998) <i>An Islamic Utopian: a political biography of Ali Shariati</i>, I.B. Tauris - Murad, A.H. "Islamic spirituality: the forgotten revolution" from http://masud.co.uk/ISLAM/ahm/fgtnrevo.htm		

6. Challenges

Challenges facing religious thought from areas such as science, secularisation, migration and multi-cultural societies and changing gender roles

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Islam and the State	- religion and the state in pre-modern Islam - secularisation and the state in modern Islam	- Sunnism: the contractual nature of the state, the complimentary roles of the ruler and the Ulama - Shi'ism: the Shi'a Imam as supreme authority, the role of the Ulama in the absence of the Imam - the identification of secularism with modernisation and social progress - the adoption of Western legal codes in modern Muslim states - opposition to secularisation in the Muslim world - the identification of secularism with Western imperialism and moral decline - the status of the Shari'a in modern Muslim states
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Islam and the state, including: - the degree to which state and religion are united according to the views of pre-modern Sunnism and Shi'ism - different reactions to secularism in the Muslim world - the status of religion in the modern Muslim nation-state	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Black, A. (2011) <i>The History of Islamic Political Thought: From the Prophet to the Present</i>, Edinburgh University Press, Part 2 - Enayat, H. (1982) <i>Modern Islamic Political Thought</i>, University of Texas Press, Chapters 1 and 3 - Hashemi, N. (2009) <i>Islam, Secularism and Liberal Democracy: Toward a Democratic Theory for Muslim Societies</i>, Oxford University Press, Chapter 4	

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Islam in Europe	- Islamic teachings on life as a religious minority - integration	- migration: the concept of <i>hijra</i> (migration for religious freedom) - religious conversion: the concept of <i>da'wa</i> (mission) in Islam - consequences of practicing the Shari'a: respecting the 'law of the land' and the concept of 'minority jurisprudence' - multiculturalism and Muslim efforts to form a European Muslim identity 'European Islam' - Mustafa Cerić's <i>Islam: A Declaration of European Muslims</i> - opponents to multiculturalism; the post-9/11 era and the spread of Islamophobia in Europe
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Islam in Europe, including: - the degree to which Islam sanctions life as a religious minority in non-Muslim lands - the challenges to tolerance and peaceful coexistence between Muslim minorities and the majority non-Muslim population - different views on the integration of Muslim communities in European society - the impact of 9/11 and its aftermath on perceptions of Islam in Europe		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful - Goody, J. (2001) <i>Islam in Europe</i>, Polity Press, Chapters 3 and 4 - Green, T. (2015) <i>The Fear of Islam: an introduction to Islamophobia in the West</i>, Fortress Press, Chapter 4 - Gilliat-Ray, S. (2010) <i>Muslims in Britain: an introduction</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapters 2 and 10		